ERA 11

Reconstruction Begins

1865 – 1866

Lincoln's plan · Johnson's Reconstruction · the Black Codes

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How should the nation rebuild the South and reincorporate four million freedpeople?

KEY TERMS

Ten Percent Plan · Wade-Davis Bill · Andrew Johnson · Black Codes · Civil Rights Act of 1866

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 5.10 · AMSCO Ch. 5.10

HOW TO REBUILD THE SOUTH?

A Shattered Nation

The Great Questions of Reconstruction

I

Readmit the States

On what terms should rebel states rejoin the Union?

II

Reincorporate the Freed

How would 4 million **freedpeople** live as citizens?

III

Who Decides?

Would the President or Congress control Reconstruction?

Two Plans for the South

Lincoln's Ten Percent Plan

Lenient

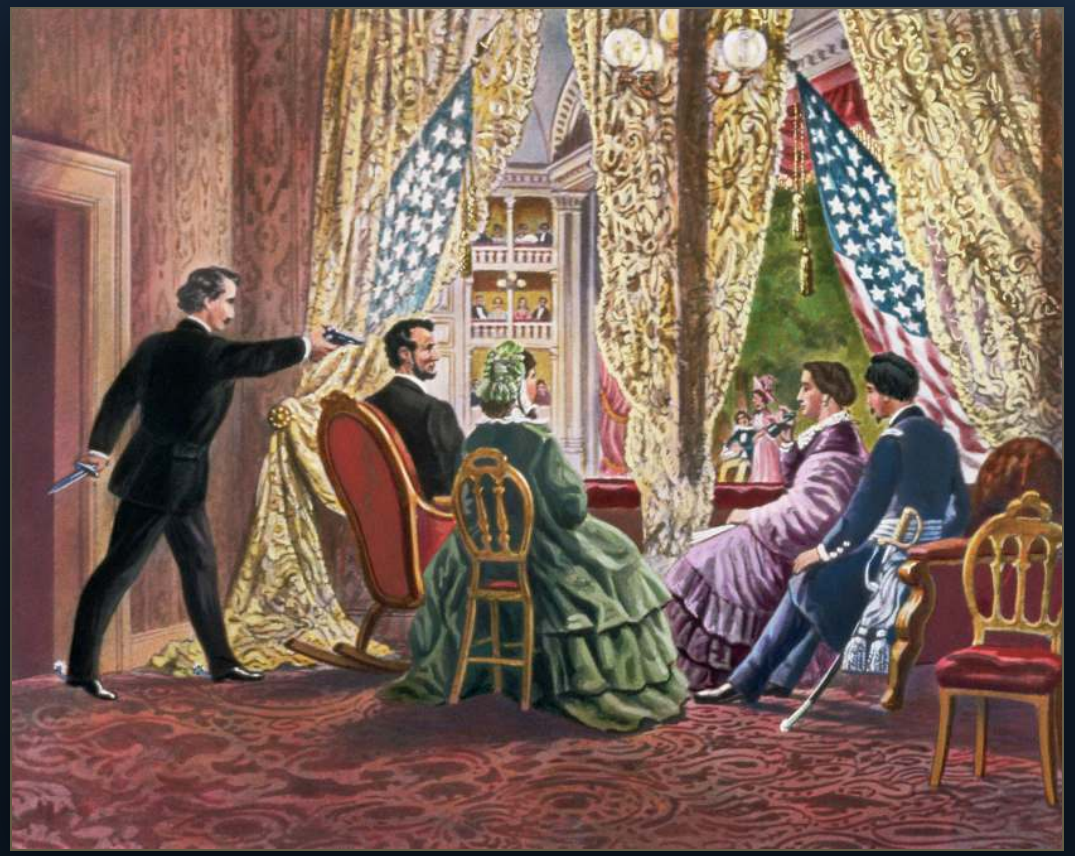
- Readmit a state when just **10%** of voters swore loyalty.
- Aimed to reunify the nation quickly and gently.
- Focused on healing, not punishment.

The Wade-Davis Bill

Harsh (Radical Republicans)

- Required a **majority** to swear loyalty.
- Demanded stronger guarantees for **freedpeople**.
- Lincoln **pocket-vetoed** it as too severe.

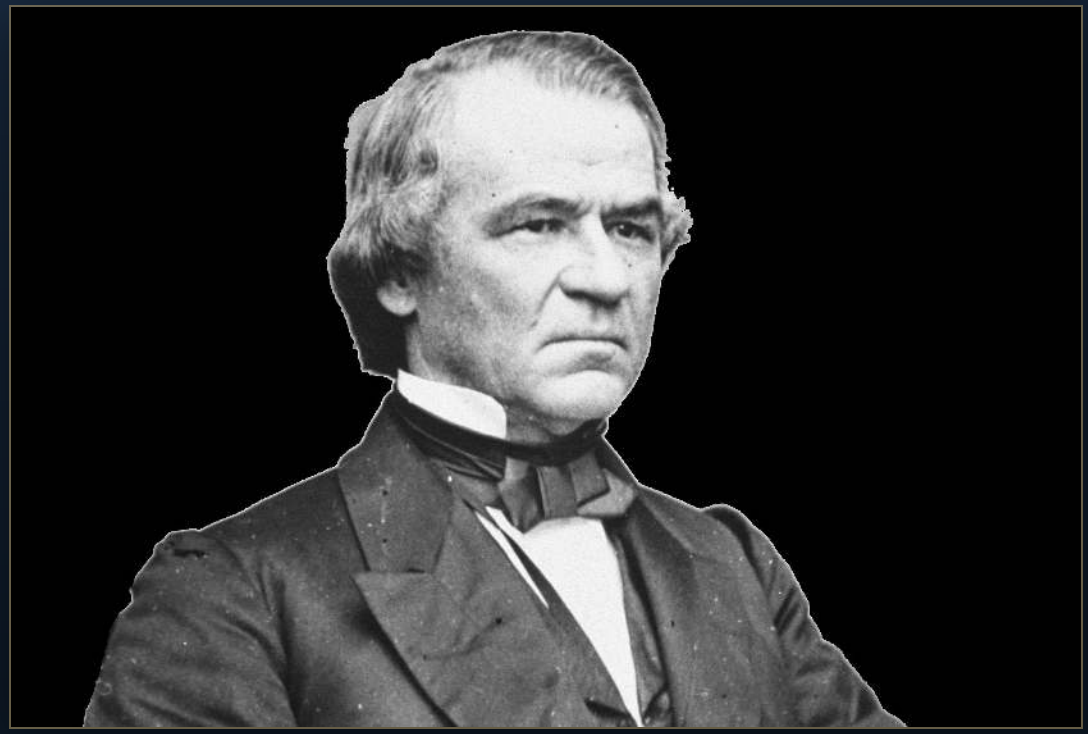
Lincoln's Assassination, 1865



- Just days after the war ended, **John Wilkes Booth** shot Lincoln at Ford's Theatre.
- Lincoln died the next morning—April 15, 1865.
- Vice President **Andrew Johnson**, a Tennessee Democrat, became president.

Presidential Reconstruction

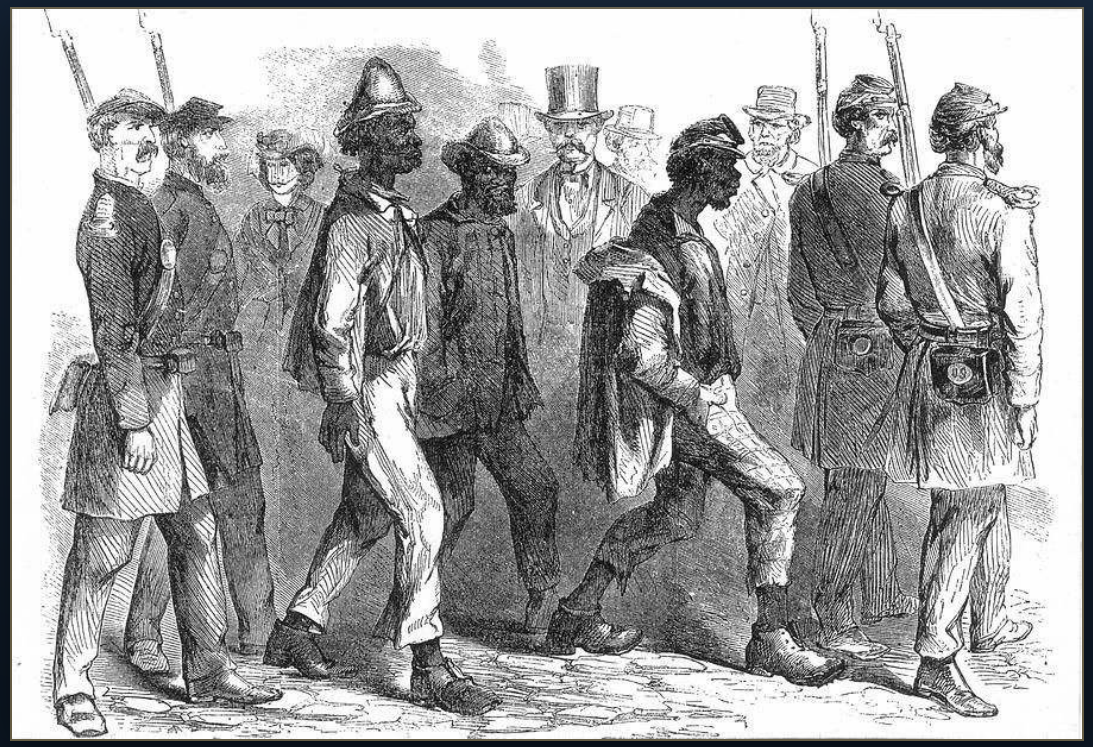
- **Andrew Johnson** pursued a lenient plan he called '**Restoration**.'
- He pardoned ex-Confederates and let them reclaim power.
- By late 1865, former Confederates were back in Southern governments.



SECTION

The South Resists

The Black Codes



- Southern legislatures passed **Black Codes** to control **freedpeople**.
- They restricted movement, forced labor contracts, and denied rights.
- Critics said they re-created slavery in all but name.

Congress Fights Back

PROVOCATION

Black Codes

The South's defiance outrages Northern Republicans.

→

RESPONSE

Civil Rights Act of 1866

Congress declares freedpeople citizens with equal rights.

→

CONFLICT

Johnson vs. Congress

Johnson vetoes it—Congress overrides him.

→

SHIFT

Congress Takes Over

The stage is set for Radical Reconstruction.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Reconstruction Begins

1. **Reconstruction** faced huge questions: how to readmit states and secure the future of four million **freedpeople**.
2. **Lincoln's assassination** put the lenient **Andrew Johnson** in charge—and ex-Confederates regained power.
3. The **Black Codes** and Johnson's leniency provoked Congress, setting up the clash of Radical **Reconstruction**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

Reconstruction Begins

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

COMPARISON

Compare **Lincoln's** and the **Radical Republicans'** visions for Reconstruction. Which was more realistic?

CAUSATION

Explain how the **Black Codes** pushed Congress toward a harsher Reconstruction.

CONTEXTUALIZATION

How did **Lincoln's assassination** change the course of Reconstruction?

Up next — **Lesson 26: Radical Reconstruction** (the amendments, Black political power & impeachment)